



What-ifs: In their maiden Ranji Trophy final, Kerala skipper Sachin Baby and his men were left with plenty of moments to reflect ON. NIRMAL HARINDRAN

categorical, though, when he called up the Kerala Cricket Association officials after being snubbed by Karnataka (Remember his heart-wrenching tweet, Dear cricket, give me one more chance?). Kerala, however, chose not to sign him. And it was not as if Kerala's batting

line-up read like Sunil Gavasker, Gordon Greenidge, Ricky Ponting, Sachin Tendulkar, Steve Waugh...

In fact, the failure of Kerala's top order had been a cause of concern.

From the 10 matches the team played, there was not even a single hundred from the batters up the

order. In fact, Kerala scored just three hundreds, which came from the middle-order duo of Salman Nizar and Mohammed Azharuddeen.

They had been superb as they shepherded the tail and helped Kerala get slender first-innings leads



Slippery hands: Akshay Chandran had dropped the catch of second-innings centurion Karun Nair early on day four. Nair made the most of the reprieve, scoring 135 in the second innings. NIRMAL HARINDRAN